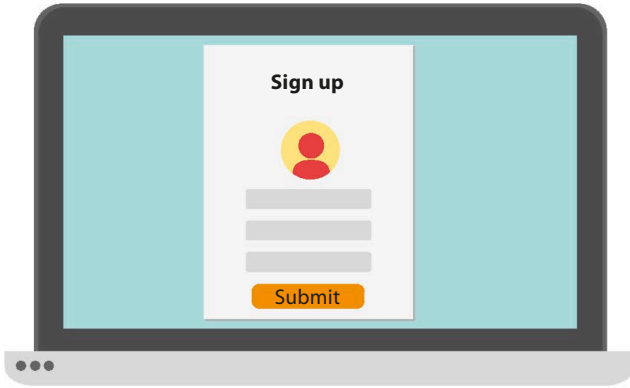


Using social media apps

Most social media apps are not as flexible or sophisticated as their web versions. Some may offer reduced interactivity or require a separate app to be downloaded to access things like direct messaging. Mobile social media apps make it easier to be more immediate with social media in comparison to their web counterparts. This might be a good thing when giving important information to others in real time, such as reacting to a natural disaster. However, this immediacy can be a bad thing if a user posts something without thinking about it first.



△ Signing up

Once an app has been downloaded on a device, the first step to access it is to link it with a new or an existing account. The same account can be used to view the app on different devices.

▷ Leaving a social media app

Deleting the app does not delete your social media account. Different apps have different terms and conditions required for completely terminating an account. Usually this is done by looking in the app settings.



“As users **replace** usage of the web with a mobile, **app-centric ecosystem**, the phone becomes the centre of gravity.”

Keith Teare (b. 1954),
British technology entrepreneur



△ Two-factor authentication

Many social media apps require two-factor authentication. This means that, in addition to a username and password, users must also enter a unique code to prove their identity. This is designed to minimize the chances the account can be broken into by an unauthorized person.

REAL WORLD

Location tracking

One of the benefits of accessing a social media app through a handheld device is that users can get information based on their current location. The app creators can track the users' locations and create more customer-specific features. However, there is a downside to this: app creators can sell this location information to third parties for their own benefit.

